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General Comment

The notion that these AI companies "need" large swaths of copyrighted material to train is absurd. OpenAI has increased the amount of training material again and again each iteration and the end result has only been modest improvements. The future of AI is going to be in making smaller models with only a select amount of data in them.

Requiring companies like OpenAI to do the bare minimum of respecting our laws and copyright system will not stall progress in AI. Companies taking the shortcut of feeding their models tons of data in the hope it makes their models better is a crutch. All it is allowing them to take the easy way out rather than doing the hard work of making their models better.

If we throw open the doors of copyright to allow AI companies to plunder our nation's IP and intellectual output, all that will happen is it will be plundered by these companies and foreign actors without compensating the people who made that data in the first place. This is good short-term for AI, but incredibly bad for the future of creative fields.

The writers, artists, programmers, speakers, and individuals who made this data deserve to protect their work or at the very least share in the profits. If we do not allow them to maintain the ability to profit from their work but allowing an AI to copy them, then they will cease to be able to produce their work. This ends up meaning that they will produce less data that could be trained on when the copyright expires.

Not only is this morally wrong, it is dangerous. It is a snake eating itself; and a system where Saturn devours his children in the name of making himself stronger is a system that crumbles - for everyone.